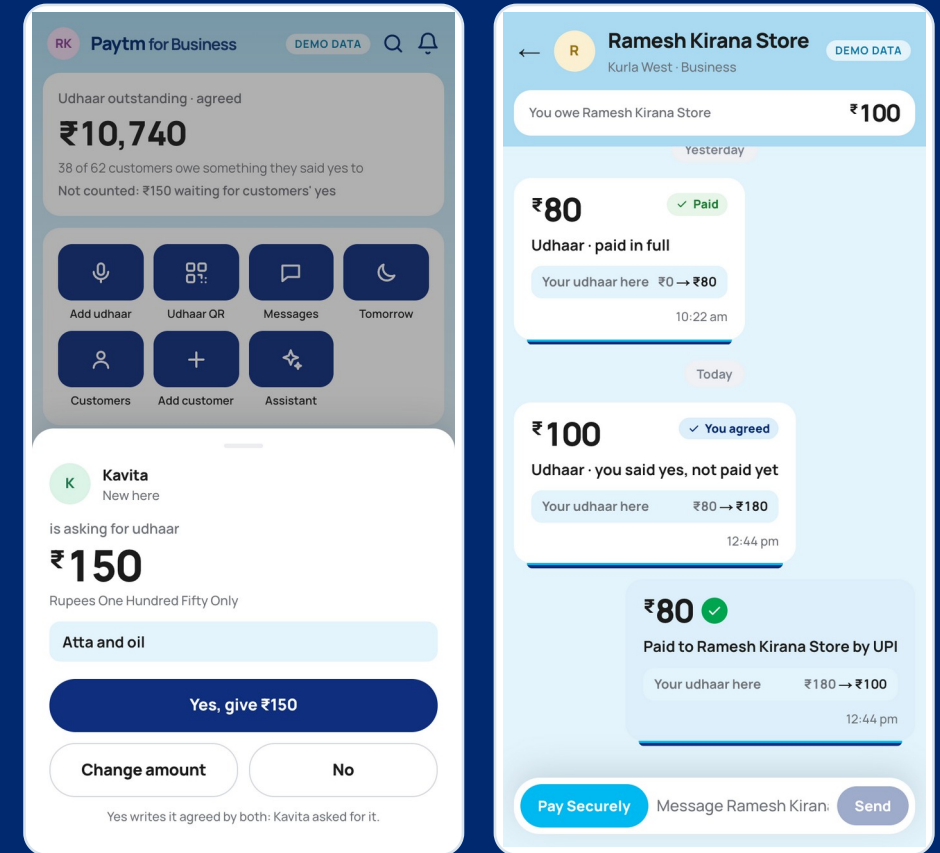


This idea was selected in the top 10 at the Paytm Build for India AI Hackathon, Mumbai

BAHI

The khata both sides can see.

The customer scans the shop's udhaar QR, or asks for udhaar on her own phone. The shopkeeper tells his AI munshi the amount, and nothing is written until both sides say yes. Every night, plain code decides who actually needs a reminder.



Shopkeeper · Customer · our working app, demo data

Paytm Build for India AI Hackathon · Mumbai, 3 October 2026

Track 2: AI-Powered Financial Journeys

Team Hustlers · picked by the Paytm panel as a top 10 project

More revenue from merchants and customers Paytm already has.

₹9

a month, added to the Soundbox plan the merchant already pays.

The customer pays nothing. There is no new device to ship and no new app to install.

Our proposed price. The numbers behind it are on slide 14.

1

Customer acquisition is already done

1.57 Cr storefronts run a Paytm Soundbox, and their customers pay with Paytm. BAHl is sold to people Paytm has already won.

2

Paytm Business Khata, made two-sided

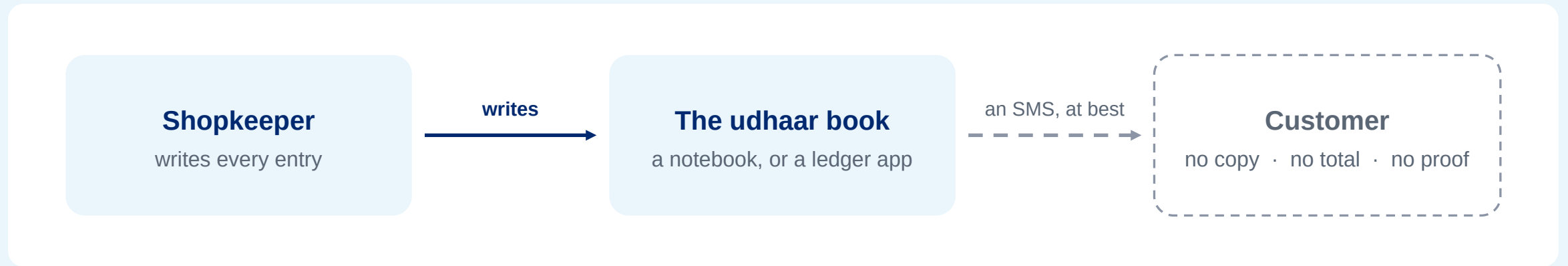
Business Khata already keeps the shop's udhaar. BAHl adds the customer's own copy, the AI munshi and the Soundbox voice.

3

Udhaar moves from cash to Paytm UPI

Every repayment is a tap in the customer's chat with the shop, paid by Paytm UPI.

The udhaar book has one author. The customer never sees it.



He can't see patterns

Someone who always pays on day 9 and someone quietly drifting away look the same in a notebook. So everyone is chased the same way.

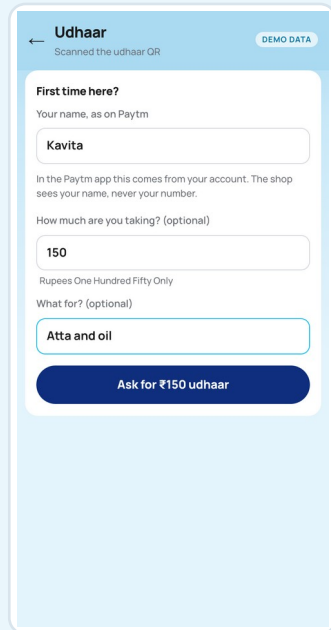
The customer has no record

He can't see what he owes across shops. If the book says ₹500 and he remembers ₹300, he has nothing to show.

Apps went digital on one side only

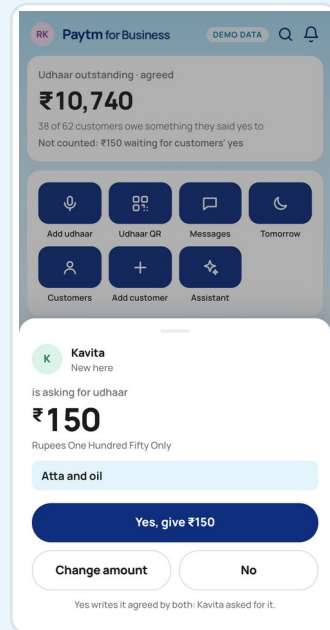
Khatabook alone has 5 Cr+ downloads. Its customers still get only an SMS — no app of their own, and no say in the entry.

One entry, agreed by both sides, inside the Paytm they already use.



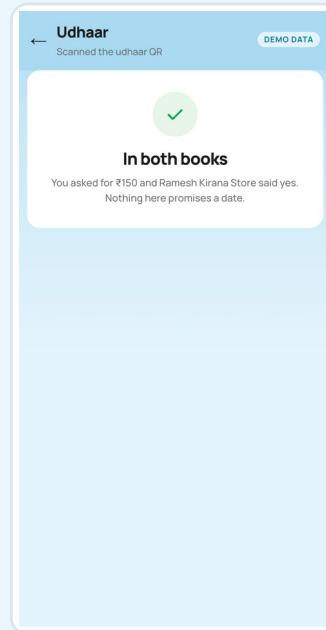
1 She scans, and can ask

A separate udhaar QR. She may say how much, and what for.



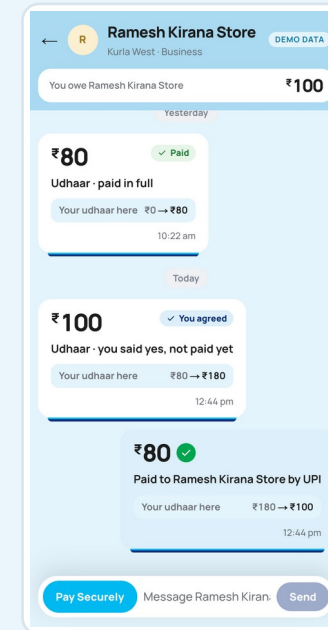
2 The shop says yes

Or says the amount to the munshi. Nothing is written before his yes.



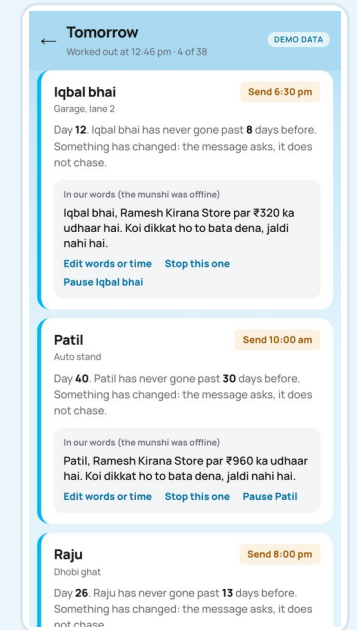
3 In both books

Her ask was her yes. Otherwise: "Yes, I owe ₹200" on her phone.



4 A chat like a passbook

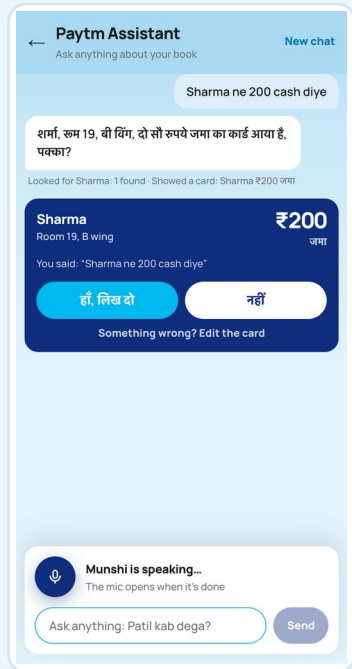
Every udhaar and payment shows the total before and after it.



5 Code picks who hears

Only people past their own longest gap. Everyone else is held, with why.

Paid in cash? He says so, and that udhaar is gone.



1

He says it

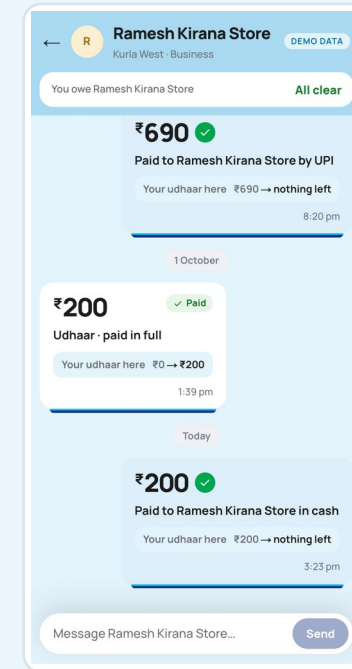
“Sharma ne 200 cash diye.” The munshi finds Sharma and puts up a जमा card for ₹200.



2

His yes writes it

The cash clears Sharma’s oldest open udhaar first. The munshi says it is written and sent.

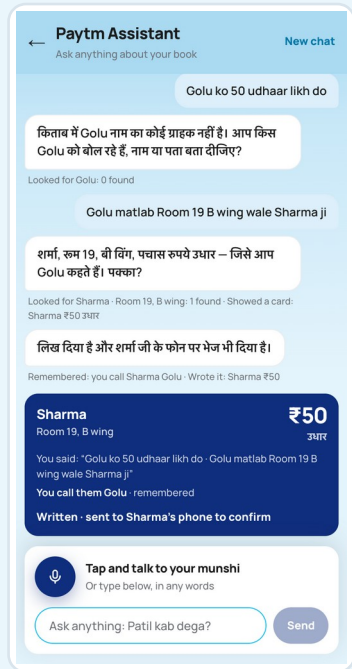


3

Gone on both sides

Sharma’s own chat shows “Paid in cash”, and his udhaar goes from ₹200 to nothing left.

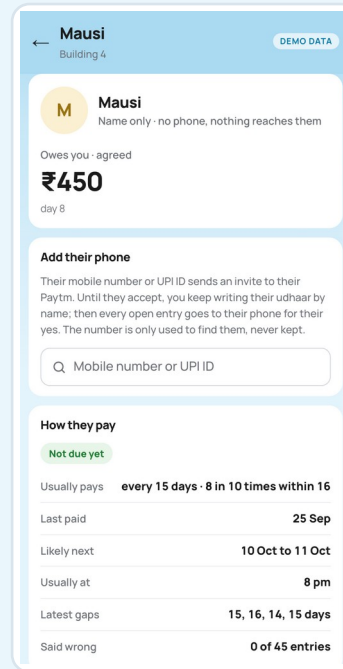
Nicknames, customers with no phone, and paying without cash.



1

Nicknames

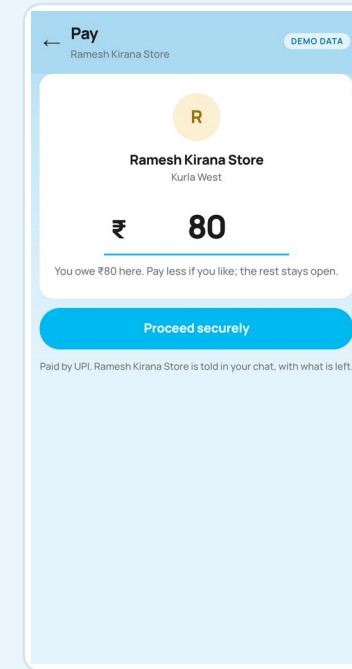
He says “Golu”. The munshi asks who that is, and remembers. Next time, “Golu” finds Sharma straight away.



2

No phone needed

A customer with no phone is kept by name, like the notebook. Add their number later and every open entry goes to them for a yes.

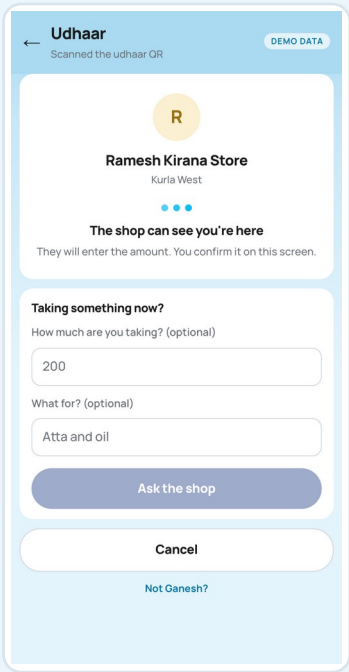


3

Cashless

The customer pays from her chat by UPI, all of it or part. The shop is told what is left.

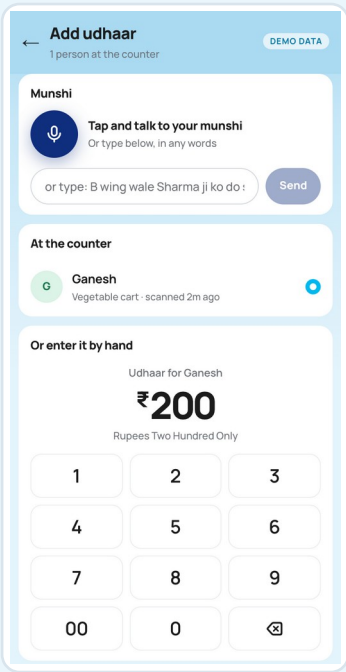
Scan the udhaar QR, and you're at the counter, first in line.



1

She scans

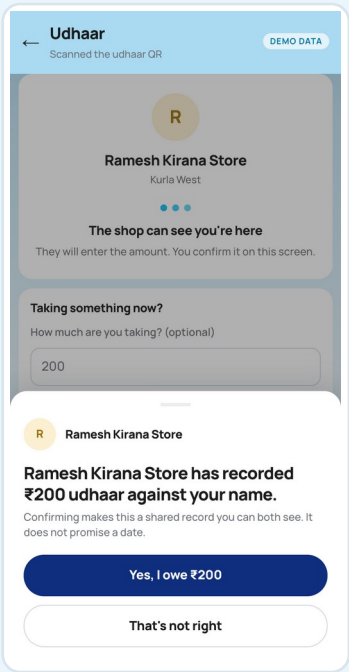
The udhaar QR puts her on the shop's counter list for three minutes. Her phone tells her the shop can see her.



2

Top of his screen

People at the counter come first. With one there, she is already picked: he says or types ₹200 and sends.



3

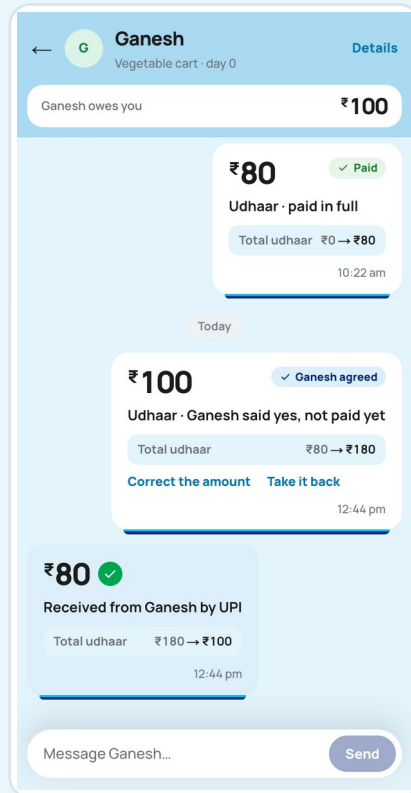
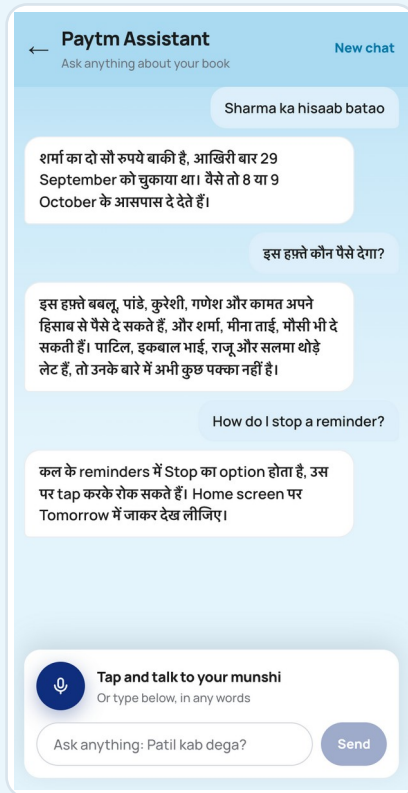
Her yes, on the spot

Her phone asks "Yes, I owe ₹200" at once, before she leaves the counter.

Five jobs for AI: hear, understand, speak, remember, predict.

THE JOB	MODEL	WHAT IT DOES	WHERE YOU SEE IT
Hear	Sarvam Saaras v4	Speech to text in whatever language is spoken, with the shop's customer names as hints.	Add udhaar by voice, the munshi
Understand	Sarvam-105B	The munshi: works out what he meant and calls our tools to find a customer, put an entry on a card or look something up.	Paytm Assistant, voice entries
Speak	Sarvam Bulbul v3	Says amounts on the Soundbox and reads the munshi's replies aloud.	Soundbox, Assistant
Remember	Cognee + pgvector	Turns notes, promises and nicknames into a knowledge graph per shop, and recalls them by meaning.	"Salary on the 7th", "Pappu is Prakash"
Predict	Pattern engine + Sarvam-105B	When each customer will likely pay, and who is drifting. The munshi says it as a guess.	Customer card, Tomorrow, "इस हफ्ते कौन देगा?"

An AI munshi that does the work, and never writes without a yes.



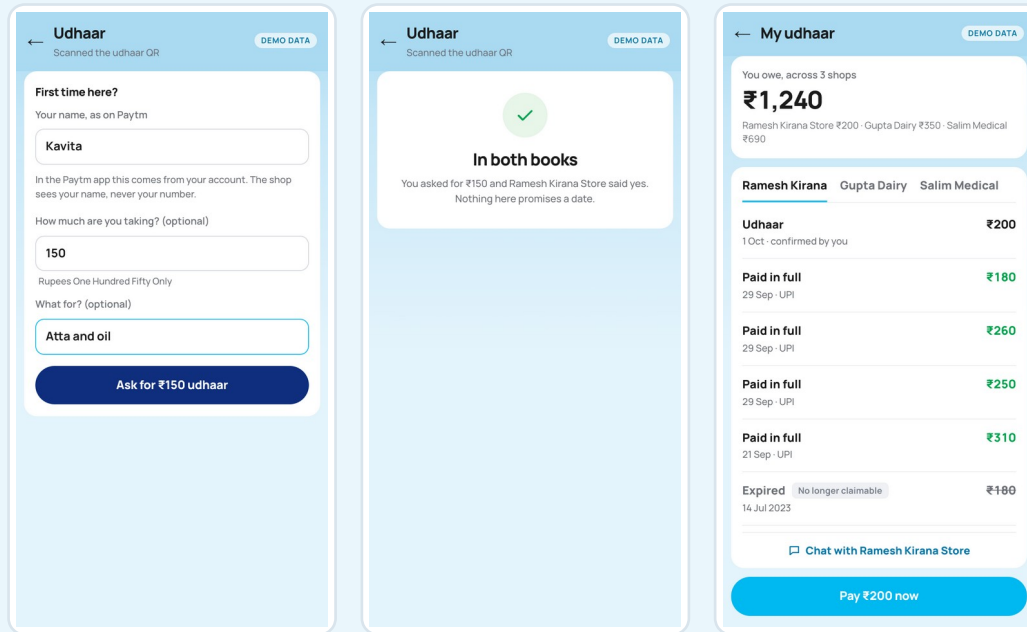
What it does

- Talk or type, in Hindi, English, Marathi or a mix. Sarvam hears any of them.
- Finds the customer by the sound of a name, or how the shop describes them.
- Asks before reading names; then says only the names.
- Puts every change on a card: an entry, a payment, a correction, taking one back, new details, a message. Only his yes writes it.
- Paytm Assistant: ask anything about the book. The chat is kept.

Its tools are our code

```
find_customer · counter · customer_card · propose_entry · propose_correction ·
propose_removal · propose_details · propose_message · remember · recall ·
expected_payments · tonight
```

Her own copy of every udhaar, inside the Paytm app she already has.

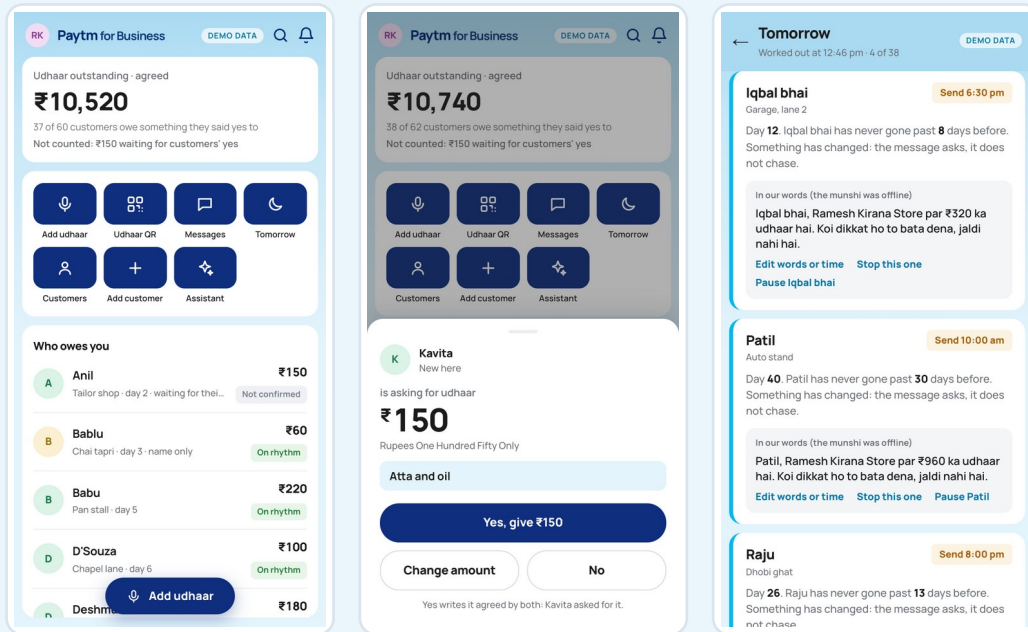


Ask · Agreed · My udhaar

What the customer can do

- Scan the shop's udhaar QR. Nothing to download: it is Paytm.
- Ask for udhaar herself: how much, and what for.
- Say yes to each entry, or tap “Not mine” or “Wrong amount”.
- A chat with each shop that reads like a passbook: the total before and after every entry.
- See what she owes across every shop, and pay by UPI, all or part.
- Reminders come privately, in her language, with no due date and no interest.

He says it once. The munshi, the Soundbox and the code do the rest.



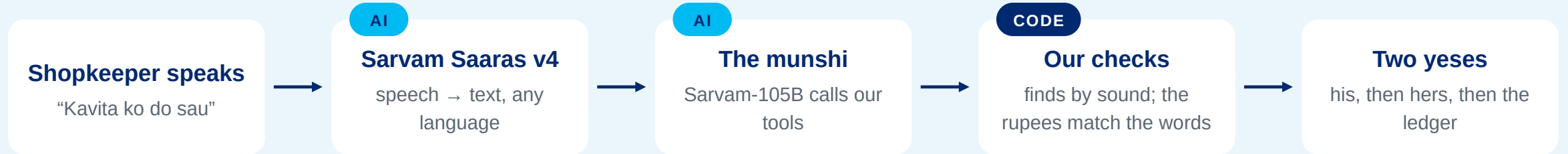
Home · A customer asks · Tomorrow

What the shopkeeper can do

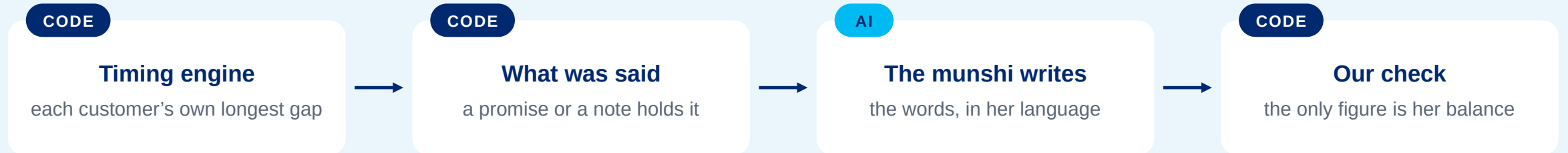
- Say the amount to the munshi in any language, or tap the keypad.
- A customer's ask pops up on his screen: Yes, No or Change amount.
- The Soundbox says the amount aloud, and never a name.
- Correct an entry or take it back, in the open.
- Ask anything: “कितना बाकी है?”, “इस हफ्ते कौन देगा?”
- BAH! remembers promises and notes, and holds a reminder for them.
- Only people late by their own pattern get a reminder. He can rewrite, move, stop or pause it.

AI understands the words. Plain code decides every number.

DURING THE DAY — RECORDING AN ENTRY



EVERY NIGHT — DECIDING WHO HEARS FROM US



How we prove it: a test fails the build if the core logic imports anything outside Python's standard library. The model only ever returns words.

STACK

Next.js 16

React 19

FastAPI

Python 3.13

PostgreSQL

Sarvam Saaras

Sarvam-105B

Bulbul v3

Cognee

Vercel · Render · Supabase

Every udhaar app serves the shopkeeper. We add the customer.

	DOWNLOADS	CUSTOMER HAS AN APP	CUSTOMER CONFIRMS ENTRIES
Khatabook	5 Cr+	No — SMS / WhatsApp	No
OkCredit	1 Cr+	No — “They don’t need the app”	No
Paytm Business Khata	Inside Paytm for Business	No — SMS with a pay link	No
BAHI	—	Yes — inside the Paytm app	Yes — one tap

Two-sided

An entry becomes a fact only when the customer confirms it.

Scan, then speak

The QR says who, his voice says how much. Nothing to type.

Timed per person

Reminders follow each customer’s own repayment pattern.

No new hardware, and ₹9 more a month from each merchant.

Easy to build and sell

- Software only. No new hardware: the Soundbox already says amounts aloud.
- Built on what Paytm has: the Paytm app, its chats, UPI, the Soundbox and Business Khata.
- Sold as an add-on line on the merchant’s existing Soundbox bill, through the Paytm for Business app and the field team.
- A standalone ledger app lost ₹116 Cr in FY24 (Khatabook). BAHl needs no app of its own and no new customers.
- We built it working, end to end, during the hackathon.

₹90 → ₹99

a month from the same merchant, with no hardware delivered. Paytm’s Soundbox plan earned about ₹90 a device a month in Q4 FY24.

Our guesstimate: merchants who add BAHl

Out of 1.24 Cr merchants paying for a Paytm device, at ₹9 a month.

TAKE-UP	MERCHANTS	NEW REVENUE A YEAR
5%	6.2 lakh	₹6.7 Cr
10%	12.4 lakh	₹13.4 Cr
25%	31 lakh	₹33.5 Cr

Not counted: udhaar repayments moving from cash to Paytm UPI.

Fewer reminders, sent only to people who are actually late.

4 of 38

customers who owe get a reminder tonight.

The other 34 are not late by their own pattern, so they hear nothing.

Our demo shop: 60 customers, six months of synthetic data.

For the shopkeeper

Stops chasing people who always pay.

Spots the ones who are drifting.

Records by voice, so the queue keeps moving.

For the customer

Sees his total across every shop.

Has proof of every entry.

Is reminded privately, not at the counter.

For Paytm

Udhaar settled in cash moves to UPI.

A daily reason to use the Soundbox.

A new reason to open the Paytm app.

We tested the voice on 1,338 recordings. It gets it right, or it asks.

How we made the 1,338 recordings

- We wrote 42 things a shopkeeper says, like “Sharma ko do sau” or “B wing wale Kamat ne 300 diye”.
- 12 voices spoke them: 10 Sarvam voices and 2 Mac voices.
- Each was played three ways: in a quiet shop, over street noise, and with a second customer talking.
- The test book had 68 customers, 20 of them named Anubhav, so picking the right person was hard.
- Every recording went through the app’s own path: Sarvam turned it into text, and our checks decided the entry.

73%**right the first time**

The right person and amount, from the words alone.

17%**one tap**

Two people fit, so it asks “Kaunse Anubhav?” and he taps the right one.

8%**said again**

It wasn’t sure, so it asked him to repeat it.

2%**wrong**

And even then, the customer still has to say yes on her phone before it counts.